



Sit anywhere you want

Noonee, a chairless chair, is an exoskeleton which lets you sit anywhere you want
<http://dgit.in/Noonee>



Successor to Flappy Bird

The creator of the viral game Flappy Bird has come up with a new game which is more difficult <http://dgit.in/SwiCopters>

Smart SoHo

player than an MBA from Harvard.” (Read more here: http://dgit.in/JSB_WoW) He noted how performance of individual players was graded at the end of each raid and how everyone was open to criticism from everyone else since their groups and the guilds that organise them were based on meritocracy.

Only the tip of the iceberg

There are other real-world scenarios where gamification has proven to be successful. NTT Data, a Tokyo-based company developed a game called *Ignite Leadership* in which employees were taught negotiating skills, time management and problem solving. And those who ranked high within the company were promoted to team leadership roles. There was even a 30 percent reduction in employees leaving the company and a bunch of money was saved on recruitment and training.

Miller Brewing, based in Milwaukee, U.S. developed a game that showed bartenders the way to pour the perfect glass of beer. Gamification isn't limited to just big corporations. It can be implemented in any vertical in any company – all you need to do is figure out your focus area.

Let's take a look at scenarios where you wouldn't have imagined gamification

could work. Marriott International launched *My Marriott Hotel* in 2011 on Facebook. It has players take up the role of managing a kitchen. Tasks involved everything from shopping for ingredients and utensils to hiring and training chefs. Players were then directed to the Marriott website's employment page where they could do it all again, for real!

Sun Microsystems taught its new employees about its company values with the aid of two game titles: *Rise of the Shadow Specters* and *Dawn of the Shadow Specters*. These games taught the new hires about the company's structure, its past and work culture. Even Microsoft released *Ribbon Hero 2*, an add-on for Office that helps train people to use the interface effectively.

An industry beckons

The gaming industry is huge, but that doesn't mean you can't carve a piece of the turkey for yourself. While working with established game developers playing games all day to test them would be lucrative, that's not the focus of this article. We're talking about working with com-



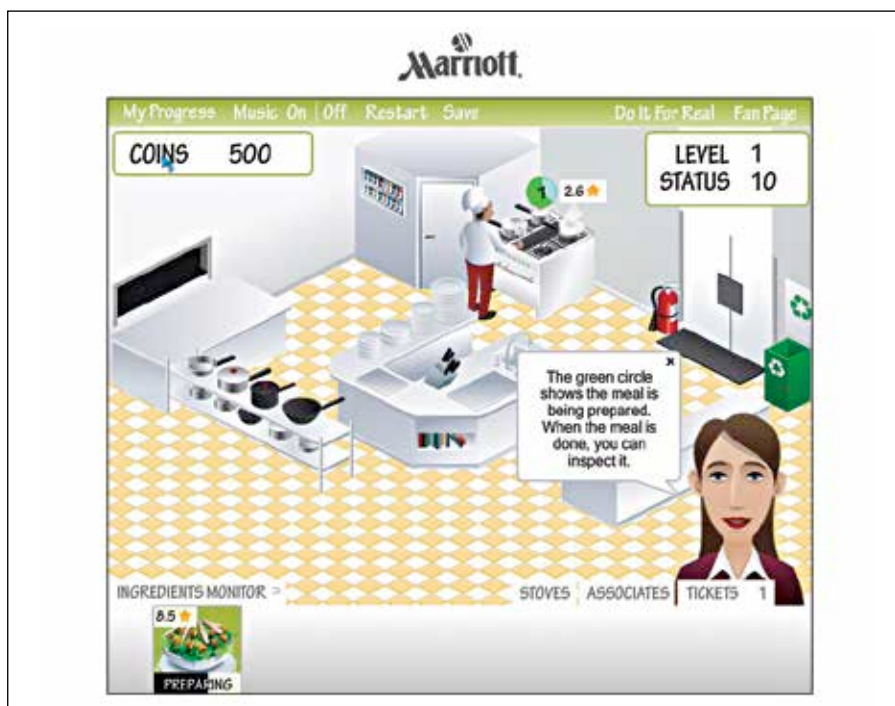
Give recognition and earn employee loyalty

panies that need developers, which will create games incorporating their company values into them. Alternatively, your next website could be gamified to reward its users the way Stack Overflow, Quora and Yahoo! Answers do.

Or you could be the next Badgeville. It's one of the many companies that help incorporate virtual rewards for employees within the intra-company network. If you've done a great job, then you'd be awarded a badge by your manager or if you were punctual, you could be awarded for that and so on. And at the end of the month, all these awards would be tallied and an employee of the month would be declared. The time is now ripe for the rise of the gamification industry. M2 Research, a market researcher has estimated that revenue from gamification software, consulting and marketing, which was around \$100 million in 2011, will reach \$2.8 billion in the U.S. alone by 2016.

Begin today

You don't have to pay any firm a million dollars to develop a custom game for you. You can come up with your own system of rewarding employees and/or set up a game room with a few consoles where employees can encash their rewards. However, plenty of prior research is critical to ensure that you don't end up making the rewards so lucrative that employees start sabotaging the work of their colleagues just to get ahead of the rest. That would be poor management on your part. On the bright side, that may mean you need to be trained to be a better manager. So buckle up and RAID! 



My Marriott Hotel, a game where you play the chef